

needed to get ahead. The bottom line is this: a prestigious education may be one indicator of potential success, but plain ole smarts fueled by hunger, drive, and grit is so much more important. And the good news for most of us is that anyone can become smarter—and for free. Books, podcasts, online training, magazines, journals, workshops, seminars, classes, and more provide wonderful, *free* opportunities to increase our knowledge—but only if we put all that new information to work. You may not get a degree certificate for your home-grown education, but the rewards could be greater than you'd ever get from a \$200,000 diploma. All the millionaires I know are lifelong learners; they're always looking for ways to increase their knowledge, because they know every new idea they can put into practice will make an immediate positive impact on their lives, business, and wealth. That's true whether they went to a private college or not.